

STARTING A WARBAND

In this part of the book, we will take a detailed look at each Warband and provide the information you need to Recruit one.

Choose a Faction

The first step in recruiting a Warband is choosing its Faction. Every Warband belongs to a Faction fighting in the Great War. A comprehensive Faction List has been provided, detailing all their models, their associated rules, and Battlekit options for each of the Factions you can use. Once you have selected your Faction (and Variant Warband if you want to use one), you can use its Faction List to recruit your warband.

Alignment

All Warbands in this book are either Faithful or Fallen. Faithful Warbands are Heavenly-aligned and fight for the holy cause. Fallen Warbands are Hell-aligned and fight for the unholy cause. The Mercenaries that can be hired for a Warband (► see Mercenaries) will also have either Faithful or Fallen alignment. Unless stated otherwise, a Warband cannot include models of the opposing alignment.

Variant Warbands

A Variant Warband represents a specialised force which has its own unique models, special rules, and Battlekit. Most Faction Lists include Variant Warbands, which can be found after the main Warband entries in the list.

Warband Special Rules

Sometimes, a Warband or a Warband Variant will have special rules. When this is the case, they will appear at the start of the Faction List or just after the description of the Warband Variant.

Recruit Your Warband

Once you have selected a Faction, you can start recruiting models. The cost to recruit a model will usually be shown in ducats (☉). The Faction List will show how many ☉ you have to spend; usually, it will be 700 ☉. Each model you recruit has a specific cost in ☉, as does any Battlekit you choose to equip them with. The Faction List includes the cost in ☉ for all the models in the Faction, along with Armoury Tables that list the cost in ☉ of Battlekit options. (► see the Trench Crusade Digital Rulebook).

Choose a Faction

Recruit your Warband

Battlekit

Special Battlekit

Warband Entries

Warband Roster Sheet

Ready for Battle

Keywords

New Antioch

Trench Pilgrims

Iron Sultanate

Heretic Legions

Black Grail

The Court

Mercenaries

As you make your choices, subtract the cost of each choice from your starting amount of **☛**. You can continue spending until you have bought everything you can, or decide to stop. Any unspent **☛** are put into your Warband's Strongbox (to represent your in-game treasury) and the **☛** can be used later or hoarded to buy something more expensive.

Glory Points

Some models and pieces of Battlekit cost Glory Points (**☼**) instead of (**☛**), **☼** are earned by performing valorous deeds in battle, as described in the Campaign section (► see Campaign in the Trench Crusade Digital Rulebook). Generally, Warbands don't have access to **☼** when they are first created, so you will probably have to wait until later on in a campaign to recruit any models that require them.

Maximum Elites

Warband can never include more than 6 models with the **ELITE** Keyword. This limit applies at all times, not just when the Warband is first recruited, and includes new models or Mercenaries that are recruited during a campaign, and any models that are promoted to **ELITE** status during a campaign (► see Campaign in the Trench Crusade Digital Rulebook).

Mercenaries

During the campaign you can use **☼** to purchase powerful troops and famous warriors known as Mercenaries. These will add both numbers and specialist abilities to your Warband. They cannot be purchased with **☛** – the only way to attract their services is to perform glorious deeds on the battlefield!

Battlekit

When you recruit a model for your Warband, you can also purchase Battlekit for the model.

WARBAND ARMOURY TABLES

The cost in ⚔ for the Battlekit that can be taken for a Warband can be found in the Armoury at the start of the Warband's Faction List. The Armoury includes an Armoury Table for each of the different types of Battlekit you can purchase, listing the cost in ⚔ and any special rules that apply to it.

Armoury Stipulations

Some of the Battlekit in the Armoury Tables have special stipulations that affect how they are chosen and can be used. Any stipulations that apply to a piece of Battlekit are listed inside brackets after its cost in ⚔. For example, a Bolt-Action Rifle has the Bayonet Lug stipulation. The stipulations in the Armoury Tables have the following effects:

- ✦ **Bayonet Lugs:** Some Ranged Weapons have “(Bayonet Lug)” after their cost in ⚔ on the Armoury Table. You must purchase a Ranged Weapon with a Bayonet Lug before you can purchase a Bayonet Melee Weapon for a model.
- ✦ **Consumable:** Some pieces of Battlekit have “(Consumable)” after their cost in ⚔. When this is the case, the Battlekit is removed from the Warband's Roster at the end of a game in which it is used.
- ✦ **“X” Only:** Some pieces of Battlekit have “(X only)” after their cost in ⚔, where “X” is the Name of a Warband Entry or a **KEYWORD**. When this is the case, the Battlekit can only be purchased for models from the Warband Entry or that have the Keyword. For example, a piece of Battlekit that has the (Death Commando Only) special rule can only be given to Death Commando models. One that has the (ELITE only) special rule can only be given to models with the ELITE Keyword.
- ✦ **Headgear:** Some pieces of Battlekit have “(Headgear)” after their cost in ⚔ on the Armoury Table. A model cannot have more than one piece of Headgear (even if it has more than one head!).
- ✦ **Limit:** Some pieces of Battlekit have “(Limit: “X”)” after their cost in ⚔. When this is the case, then your Warband cannot have more than “X” pieces of the Battlekit. For example, if a Weapon has (Limit: 2) after its cost, then you can have a maximum of two such Weapons for your whole Warband. If you lose any Limit “X” Battlekit over the course of a campaign, you can buy replacements for them (as long as you have enough ⚔ in your Strongbox to pay for them).
- ✦ **Shield Combo:** Some pieces of Battlekit have “(Shield Combo)” after their cost in ⚔ on the Armoury Table. A model can have a Shield and a 2-Handed Weapon if both have the “(Shield Combo)” rule.

What You See is What You Get

We recommend that the Battlekit you choose for your models should be visibly represented on the models themselves, so that you and your opponent can tell at a glance what a model is equipped with. If, for any reason, you cannot do this, before the game starts, it is your duty to make sure that your opponent is fully aware of all of the Battlekit that the models in your Warband are carrying.

Special Battlekit

The Special Battlekit section of each Faction List follows its Armoury section and includes Weapon Profiles and special rules for items of Battlekit available only to that Faction. Weapon Profiles and special rules for all other Battlekit options can be found in the standard Battlekit section of the rules (► see Battlekit in the Trench Crusade Digital Rulebook).

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5. **Battlekit:** The Battlekit that the model always starts with, and any other pieces of Battlekit that can be purchased for it. (Battlekit a model starts with is included in its cost.)
6. **Abilities:** If the model has any unique special abilities not covered by the Core and Comprehensive rules, they will be described here.
7. **Keywords:** Any Keywords the model has will be listed here (► see Keywords).

Purchasable Abilities

Some Warbands allow you to purchase optional abilities for your models, such as the Goetic Powers of the Court of the Seven-Headed Serpent. Unless otherwise specified, these abilities cannot be purchased more than once for the same model, and can only be purchased when a model is recruited for a Warband.

Warband Roster Sheet

You'll need a Warband Roster Sheet to record the details of your Warband. Blank Warband Roster Sheets can be downloaded from trenchcrusade.com.

When you recruit your Warband, take a Warband Roster Sheet and write down the details of each model and their Battlekit. It is a good idea to work out the Warband on a piece of scrap paper first, as you will work out which models and Battlekit you take to get the best possible value for your Warband.

You will need to name your Warband and each of the models in it. The names are yours to create. You will find plenty of inspiration throughout this book.

Ready for Battle

Your Warband is now ready. The Great War awaits! You can either use your Warband in a one-off game, or in the first game of a campaign.